

STATE DEPARTMENT OF FISH AND WILDLIFE

Wildlife Research Permitting & Enforcement Division

Reference No. FWD-2026-8850

Date of Issue: 16 October 2026

Dr. Ines Calder
Principal Investigator
Sable Ridge Wolf Study

RE: Acknowledgment of Incident Report FWD-2026-8850 — Suspected Illegal Take, Collared Wolf "Basalt"

Dear Dr. Calder,

This letter acknowledges receipt of your incident report, submitted 11 October 2026, concerning the suspected illegal take of the collared wolf identified as Basalt on or about 8 October 2026. This Department's enforcement division has opened a formal investigation, reference number FWE-2026-2214, and has taken custody of the recovered collar as physical evidence.

Your written statements and those of your field technician regarding the vehicle observed on 4 and 6 October have been entered into the investigation file. Enforcement staff will follow up directly with your office if additional detail or a formal interview is required.

Regarding your research permit, this Department confirms the following:

1. Your current research permit remains valid and in good standing; this incident does not affect your authorization to continue collaring and monitoring activity within the study boundary.
2. The Department recommends, but does not require, that field personnel avoid solo work near the western boundary logging spur pullout until the investigation concludes.
3. Any future observations of the described vehicle, or similar suspicious activity, should be reported directly to the enforcement division at the contact below rather than logged solely in your internal field notes, to ensure timely investigative follow-up.

The Department appreciates your team's prompt reporting and site preservation, which materially assisted the initial investigation. Please retain both reference numbers above for any future correspondence.

Sincerely,

T. Marchetti

Division Supervisor, Wildlife Research Permitting & Enforcement
State Department of Fish and Wildlife

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